

Title: Leon: The Game

1. Game Overview

a. **Core Concept:** A narrative-driven stealth-action where a professional cleaner teaches his 12-year-old apprentice to kill, and she teaches him how to live.

b. **Unique Selling Points:**

i. The contrast between mundane routine and ruthless missions.

ii. An agile partner, whom you can give orders to.

iii. A partner-switching system ("Headhunt" missions only, levels are thoughtfully designed).

iv. The influence of daily routine on mission stats.

v. The mirroring player's actions.

c. **Genre:** Narrative Stealth-Action, Immersive Sim, Interactive Movie.

d. **Target Audience:** Mature 18+ males and females. Fans of cinematic narrative games (*The Last of Us*, *God of War*, *A Plague Tale*), tactical stealth-actions (*Hitman*, *Max Payne*, *MGS*, *Splinter Cell*), immersive sims (*Dishonored*, *Deus Ex*), and interactive movies (*Heavy Rain*, *Life is Strange*) . Fans of the original cult film.

e. **Platform(s):** PC.

2. Story

a. **Plot Summary:** A professional killer, Leon, reluctantly saves Mathilda, a 12-year-old girl, after her family is brutally murdered by corrupt DEA agent Stansfield. Bursting with grief, she begs Leon to teach her the killer's craft, so she can get a long-awaited revenge.

b. **Branching Paths/Player Choices:** The game has a linear structure. However, some of the player's actions may have certain consequences, such as new abilities,

buffs/debuffs to existing ones, or changes in dialogue or character behaviour.

c. Characters

i. Protagonist(s):

- **Leon:**

- Hidden tank.
- Able to climb onto the ceiling.
- Uses a variety of weapons (Beretta 92fs, Ruger SP101, S&W Model 586, Spectre M4, Ithaca 37).
- Can control Mathilda.
- Time dilation.
- Plant Care stabilizes aim.
- Ironing Clothes reduces noise.
- Drinking Milk improves stamina and resistance.
- Training increases loadout capacity.
- Speaking and playing with Mathilda makes her more obedient + provides synchronized combat moves.

- **Mathilda**

- Cannon glass.
- Teaching Leon to read buffs the duration/strength of Leon's active skills. Also allows deciphering documents/notes found in levels.
- After target practice, Mathilda misses less often and lands critical hits.
- Heart-to-heart conversations reduce input lag for commands. Neglect makes her stubborn or slow to react.
- Playing games and speaking with Leon open teamwork moves.
- As she watches TV, she provides better audio cues and highlights secret paths and loot.
- Gymnastics increases her carry capacity for supplies.

ii. Antagonist(s):

- **Norman Stansfield:**

- Mr. X meets Doom Guy.
- Uses a shotgun, granates.
- Takes pills for rate of fire and abilities.
- Unpredictably appears from elsewhere.
- BETHOWEN.

iii. Supporting Characters:

- **Tony:**

- Quest Giver.
- Bank.
- Shop.

- **Matilda's family:**

- Father, Stepmother, Sister, Little Brother.
- Narrative Triggers.

- **Malky:**

- Flanker.
- Uses Ithaca 37 "Stakeout" as a primary gun, Smith & Wesson 659 as a secondary one.

- **Hotel Administrator:**
 - NPC.
- **SWAT:**
 - **THE POINTMAN:**
 - Uses ballistic shield + pistol (Sig Sauer).
 - Invulnerable for bullets
 - Goes slowly, defending others.
 - Counter play: shoot him in the leg (it will open); Use a grenade; Enter from the flank (Matilda can distract).
 - **THE OPERATOR:**
 - HK MP5A3 with a flashlight or M4 Carbine
 - Work in pairs.
 - Actively uses grenades (Flashbang or Smoke).
 - Heavy armor.
 - Counter play: headshots, armor-piercing cartridges.
 - **THE SNIPER:**

- Uses sniper rifle
- Not an actual NPC, just red flashlights in the air (Crossing a light is followed by a shot with a 0.5 sec lag).
- Blind zones.
- **THE GRENADIER**
 - Uses M79 Grenade Launcher to smoke a player out.

- **Clients.**

d. Setting

i. Key Locations: Tony's restaurant, Leon's home, Mathilda's apartment, hotel room 1, sniper roof, hotel room 2, motel (plenty of them), restaurant, hotel room 2, DEA office, school (yard).

ii. World History and Lore: '90s New York.

3. Gameplay

a. Core Gameplay Loop The core loop relies on the narrative needs. Basically, a player completes a **Contract** (Mission), takes a rest in a **Hub** (Sanctuary), and goes for a **Walk** (Narrative/Bonding). However, the loop isn't a prisoner; the chain sequence adapts dynamically to the current story episode.

b. Mechanics and Features

i. Contracts (The Mission)

- **LEON (The Professional):**

- **Combat:**

- Shoots, Cuts (Melee), Chokes (Non-lethal, 5 sec).
- Throws grenades (rare resource).
- **Dual Wielding:** Unlockable skill (High DPS, No Aim).
- **C.A.R. System:** Automatic stance switch near walls for close-range shooting.

- **Cleaner's Focus:** Time Dilation.

- Game speed 0.5x, Player speed 0.8x.
 - Costs 10 stamina/sec.

- **Last Stand:** After lethal damage, Leon has 5 seconds for Mathilda to save him. No auto-regen.

- **Environmental Interactivity:**

- **Stealth:** Hiding bodies, shooting lights to create shadows, hiding in shadows/curtains.

- **Cover:** Penetrates soft covers (drywall, doors). Uses verticality (ladders, holes in floor).

- **Hazards:** Walking on glass shards creates noise events.

- **Tactics:** Can unlock rooms to use as cover. Throws objects (knives/props).

- **MATHILDA (The Apprentice):**

- **Support:** Uses a pistol and a knife (for finishers only). No melee.

- **Utility:** Sets traps (distractions with toys/voice). Provides supplies (Ammo/Meds). Highlights enemies.

- **Stealth:** Hides in small places (under beds, vents, closets).
- **Control:**
 - **Civilian Control:** Keeps civilians at gunpoint to prevent alarms.
 - **Spotter:** Uses CCTV rooms to mark enemies through walls.
- **Character Switch:** Available at high Trust levels.

ii. Hub (The Sanctuary):

● **LEON:**

- **Plant Care:** Reduces Weapon Sway by 30% (Steady Hands).
- **Drinking Milk:** Grants +25 Temporary HP (Iron Gut).
- **Ironing:** Reduces Movement Noise by 20% (Silent Step).
- **Calisthenics:** Push-ups/Abs QTE.
Temporarily increases Carry Weight and Damage Resistance.
- **Save Game:** Sleeping in the chair.

● **MATHILDA (Progression):**

- **Literacy Lessons:** Increases Leon's Ability Duration by 20%. Unlocks "**Decipher**" trait (reads lore/codes).
- **Target Practice:** Increases Mathilda's Accuracy by 30% and Crit Chance by 15%.
- **Heart-to-Heart:** Reduces Command Input Lag to 0.1s. Neglect increases lag to 1.0s.
- **Playing Games:** Unlocks "**Sync-Kill**" moves (Dual Takedowns).
- **Watching TV:** Highlights enemies/loot in 15m radius.
- **Gymnastics:** Adds +2 Slots to Mathilda's Inventory.

iii. Walks (Uneasy Exploration):

- **Social Stealth:**

- "Blending In" zones (Benches, Phone booths).
- "Face Hiding" mechanic to lower suspicion meter near police.

- **Timing Puzzles:** Breaking locks/glass masked by environmental noise (trains/thunder).
- **Co-op Traversal:**
 - Boosting Mathilda to reach high ladders.
 - Mathilda opening locked gates from the inside (vents).
- **The Leash (Escort Logic):**
 - Mathilda gets distracted by POIs (Toys, Animals). Leon must signal her to regroup.
 - Holding hands limits speed but prevents separation/getting lost.
- **Bonding (Romance & Naivety):**
 - **Awkward Gifts:** Buying "inappropriate" gifts (dolls) which she wears in the Hub.
 - **Tactile Interaction:** Buying snacks from vending machines, drying hair, covering with a blanket.
- **Scavenging:** Collecting loose change (for logistics) and Intel (Newspapers, Eavesdropping) to reveal map markers.

c. Controls

- **Perspective:** TPS (Over-the-shoulder). RMB zooms in/reduces FOV. Crouching lowers camera height.
- **Physics:** Leon (Heavy, inertial). Mathilda (Light, quick response). No Jump (Vault/Climb only).
- **Keybinding:**
 - **WASD:** Move
 - **Shift:** Crouch / Face Hide
 - **Space:** Climb / Vault / Context Action
 - **LMB:** Shoot / Melee
 - **RMB:** Aim / Scope
 - **Q:** Command Mathilda
 - **E:** Interact
 - **1-4:** Weapon Select

d. Objectives

i. Short-term Goals (Tactical):

- **Execute the Hit:** Eliminate the target confirm the kill.

- **Ghost Protocol:** Remain undetected or eliminate witnesses before they trigger an alarm.
- **The Escort:** Ensure Mathilda's safety during extraction.
- **Scavenge:** Secure resources (milk, ammo, painkillers) for the Hub phase.

ii. Long-term Goals (Strategic):

- **The Exit Strategy:** Amass enough money to leave the city forever.
- **** The Legacy:**** Train Mathilda from a helpless victim into a self-sufficient survivor.
- **The Revenge:** Track down and kill Norman Stansfield.

e. Progression Systems

i. Character Growth (Trust & Economy):

- **Economy (Tony's Shop):** Money earned from contracts is used to buy weapon upgrades (silencers, scopes, extended mags), body armor, and tools (lockpicks, tripwires).

- **Trust Level (The Bond):** Interaction with Mathilda (Hub/Walks) unlocks new tactical options and dialogue branches.
- **Practice Makes Perfect:** Skills improve through use. Example: Successful stealth kills slightly reduce noise generation over time.

ii. Unlockable Abilities (Skill Tree)

LEON (The Cleaner):

- **Hair Trigger:** Increases fire rate with pistols by 20%.
- **Surgical Precision:** Increases Critical Hit Damage (Headshots) by 50%.
- **Piano Wire (Garrote):** Replaces standard choke. Silent lethal takedown takes only **2 seconds** (instead of 5).
- **The Noose (Lasso):**
 - *Action:* Throws a cord to drag a distant enemy towards Leon.
 - *Effect:* Holds enemy for 5 seconds (choking). Player can finish them (Kill) or release (Enemy falls,

injured but alive). Useful for dragging targets into dark rooms.

- **Dual Wielding:** High DPS, No Aim.
- **Cleaner's Focus:** Time Dilation (0.5x speed).
- **Flow Like Water:** Reduces movement noise by 20%.
- **Catch!:** Throws environmental objects for instant stun/kill.
- **Oh, It's So Quiet:** +15% Speed to stealth kill animations.
- **Firefly:** Increases detection delay in light by 1s.
- **Strong as a Mountain:** -50% Stamina cost for vertical actions.
- **The Professional:** +35% Weapon Damage.
- **Iron Grip:** Reduces hip-fire recoil (C.A.R. stance).
- **Shadow Step:** Silent Crouch Sprint.
- **The Ring Trick:** Grenade Radius +25%, Damage +15%.

MATHILDA (The Apprentice & Playable):

- **Home Alone:** Ability to set multiple traps (marbles, noise makers) in a sequence.

- **Ventriloquist:** Mimics noises (cry/scream) to lure enemies to a specific spot.
- **Small Target:** 30% Passive Evasion chance (enemies miss).
- **Ghost Child:** Active Skill. For **5 seconds**, enemies completely ignore Mathilda (Social Stealth/Blending), allowing her to cross open areas or flank.
- **Silent Soles:** Passive. Movement is 100% silent even when running.
- **Monster Under the Bed:** Allows using actions (Shoot, Distract, Spot) *while* hiding inside closets, under beds, or in vents.
- **Tantrum:** Throws an object or screams, stunning enemies in a small radius for 3 seconds (Non-lethal).
- **Fast Learner:** +20% Firearm Damage.
- **Vicious Strike:** +50% Critical Hit Damage (Knife/Pistol).
- **Rapid Response:** +20% Fire Rate.
- **Finisher Efficiency:** +15% Speed to Takedown animations.
- **Distraction Mastery:** Distracted enemies stay investigating for +3 seconds longer.

- **Medic:** Heals/Revives Leon 2x faster.
- **Pickpocket:** Steals loot by walking past enemies.
- **Spotter's Eye:** Marked enemies take +20% Damage.

DUO (Synergy & Co-op Moves):

- **Sync-Kill:** Cinematic simultaneous takedown on two adjacent targets.
- **Death From Above:** Leon drops from the ceiling/ledge while Mathilda sweeps the legs.
- **Bonnie & Clyde:** Ultimate Ability. Both characters fire simultaneously (Quad Wielding logic) with unlimited ammo for 5 seconds.

iii. Companion Commands (Command Wheel)

- *Logic:* Accessed via **Hold Q** (Wheel) or **Tap Q** (Context Action).
1. **Open Fire:** Attack the marked target immediately.

2. **Lure:** Use voice/objects to draw enemy attention to Mathilda's position.
3. **Clean Up:** Finish off a wounded/downed enemy (saves Leon's time).
4. **Vanish:** Immediately find the closest hiding spot and stay there.
5. **Watch Them:** Keep civilians/surrendered enemies at gunpoint (Crowd Control).
6. **Spot:** Highlight enemies and loot in the area.
7. **Eyes On:** Go to the nearest CCTV console and mark enemies through walls.
- *Passive Behaviors:* Supply Mule (Toss ammo/meds), Hint System (Voice cues).

f. Failure States/Conditions

- **Lethal Damage:** Leon's HP hits 0 and Mathilda fails to revive him within 5 seconds.
- **Companion Death:** Mathilda is killed.
- **The Code Violation:** Killing women or children triggers an instant "Contract

Failed" screen (Tony refuses to work with you).

- **Police Overrun:** Allowing too many civilians to call 911 results in an insurmountable SWAT response (Soft Lock / Death by overwhelming force).
- **Arrest:** Getting caught by police during a "Walk" (unarmed phase).

4. Art and Sound

a. Art Style Concept: "American Grit, French Soul." 90s Realism through the lens of a graphic novel. High contrast, deep shadows, cinematic framing.

i. Visual References/Inspiration:

- **Cinema:** *Léon: The Professional* (Base), *Taxi Driver* (Night city atmosphere), *Seven* (Grime and rain).
- **Games:** *Control* (Concrete and lighting), *Max Payne 1-2* (Noir comic style), *Kane & Lynch 2* (Camera grit).
- **Camera:** Wide-angle close-ups (Fisheye for Stansfield). Dutch tilts during danger.

ii. Color Palette:

- **Safety (Leon's World):** Tungsten Warmth. Yellow, orange, brown. Old lamps, sun through blinds. "The Womb."
- **Danger (The Streets/DEA):** Fluorescent Cold. Green, blue, sterile white. Neon signs, office lights, cold concrete.
- **Accent: Blood Red.** Violence must look shocking against the grey city.

iii. Character Designs:

- **Leon:** Texture-heavy. Rough wool coat, knit beanie, round glasses (reflections). A walking silhouette/wall.
- **Mathilda:** 90s Grunge. Choker, oversized bomber jacket, leggings, combat boots. Sharp, angular animations.
- **Stansfield:** Beige suit (bright spot in a dark room). Sweaty, dishevelled, manic eyes.

iv. Environment Aesthetics:

- **Claustrophobia:** Narrow hotel corridors, cluttered apartments, tight stairwells.

- **Decay:** Peeling paint, rusty radiators, steam from manholes, trash piles.
- **Atmosphere:** Volumetric fog (dust in light beams), wet asphalt, constant rain/dampness.

b. Sound Concept: "Industrial Heartbeat."
Orchestral tension mixed with city noise.

i. Musical Style:

- **Genre:** Industrial Trip-Hop / Dark Ambient / Orchestral.
- **Vibe:** Eric Serra (*Léon OST*), Massive Attack, Portishead.
- **Dynamic:** Music reacts to the "Heartbeat/Stress" level.

ii. Themes/Motifs:

- **Leon:** Low, rhythmic bass/contrabass. Heavy, like an elephant's step.
- **Mathilda:** Melancholic violin or toy piano. Starts shy, becomes aggressive/distorted later.
- **Stansfield:** Classical music (Beethoven) but distorted and uncomfortable.

iii. Sound Effects:

- **Gunplay:** Deafening, dry, "painful" cracks. Heavy echo indoors. Shell casings hitting the floor are loud.
- **Foley (Tactile):** Leather creaking, keys jingling, milk carton opening, footsteps on glass.
- **Silence:** During "Focus" (Time Dilation), world mutes (Low Pass Filter), hearing only Leon's breath and the trigger mechanism.

5. Level Design

- a. Level Structure and Flow
- b. Objectives within Levels
 - i. Puzzles
 - ii. Combat Encounters
 - iii. Collectibles
- c. Environmental Hazards/Obstacles
- d. Level Progression and Pacing

6. User Interface (UI)

- a. Menus
 - i. Main Menu
 - ii. Options Menu
 - iii. Inventory/Character Management
- b. HUD (Heads-Up Display)
 - i. Health Bars/Status Indicators
 - ii. Maps/Navigation
 - iii. Objective Markers

7. Technical Requirements

- a. Game Engine
- b. Hardware Requirements
 - i. Minimum System Specs (PC)
 - ii. Recommended System Specs (PC)
 - iii. Console Features (Console)
- c. Third-party Software/Plugins/Middleware
 - i. Physics Engines
 - ii. AI Systems
 - iii. Audio Tools